

D217

Accounting Information Systems

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A furniture manufacturer with a showroom in Chicago receives a customer order, ships the sofas, bills the customer, and collects payment. Its warehouse uses barcode scanners installed last year. Which transaction cycle covers these steps?

- A. Revenue cycle.
- B. General ledger and reporting cycle.
- C. Production cycle, because warehouse scanners track inventory.
- D. Expenditure cycle.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

At a nonprofit with a \$3 million budget, one staff member opens the mail, deposits donor checks, and posts the receipts to the donor ledger. She has worked there eleven years and is trusted by the board. Which change best fixes the control weakness?

- A. Require her to take a yearly vacation.
- B. Also have her reconcile the bank statement each month.
- C. Assign opening and depositing checks to one person and posting to the ledger to another.
- D. Keep the setup, given her long, trusted record.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An employee can both add new vendors to the vendor master file and approve payments to vendors. What fraud does this combination make easiest?

- A. Lapping customer receipts.
- B. Creating a fake vendor and approving payments to it.
- C. None, because both duties are authorization tasks.
- D. Adding ghost employees to payroll.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A payroll clerk at a hospital with 2,000 employees keys 400 instead of 40.0 in the hours-worked field for one nurse. The system, upgraded in January, rejects the entry because no one can work more than 80 hours in a pay period. Which input control caught the error?

- A. Field check.
- B. Limit check.
- C. Validity check.
- D. Completeness check.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company wants to catch transposed digits in customer account numbers, such as 4721 keyed as 4271. Which control fits best?

- A. Batch record count.
- B. Sequence check.
- C. Limit check.
- D. Check digit verification.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A clinic network's database has a Patients table with primary key PatientID and an Appointments table. Each appointment belongs to one patient, and a patient can have many appointments. The database runs on servers in a data center two states away. How should the tables be linked?

- A. Copy all patient details into every appointment row.
- B. Make PatientID the primary key of Appointments.
- C. Link the tables by patient last name.
- D. Store PatientID in Appointments as a foreign key referencing Patients.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A distributor with 14 warehouses replaces its separate sales, inventory, and accounting programs with an ERP system. Its IT director came from a video-game company. What is the main benefit, and what is a main risk?

- A. Integrated, real-time data across functions; costly, complex implementation where errors spread across modules.
- B. It removes the need for internal controls; no major risk.
- C. Each department keeps its own database for flexibility.
- D. Game-style dashboards; risk limited to the IT director's learning curve.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A bank with 1.2 million customers is replacing its core deposit system. Errors would be very costly, and the budget can support running two systems for a quarter. The project manager holds a PMP certificate. Which conversion method gives the lowest risk?

- A. Parallel conversion.
- B. Direct conversion.
- C. Pilot conversion.
- D. Phased conversion, since it is always the safest method.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A small firm switches from its old billing system to the new one overnight on a single date. Which method is this, and what is its key drawback?

- A. Parallel conversion; the cost of running two systems.
- B. Direct conversion; it is the most expensive method.
- C. Direct conversion; there is no fallback if the new system fails.
- D. Pilot conversion; results are limited to one site.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

An analyst at an insurance company with 600 agents needs a diagram showing where claims data comes from, which processes transform it, and where it is stored, without showing who does the work, which forms are used, or which computer runs it. The analyst prefers blue shapes. Which tool fits?

- A.** A system flowchart.
- B.** A data flow diagram.
- C.** A document flowchart.
- D.** An entity-relationship diagram.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

An IT auditor at a retailer with 300 stores finds that programmers can move code changes into production without approval. The retailer's point-of-sale screens were recently redesigned. What type of control is deficient, and why does it matter?

- A.** An application input control.
- B.** It does not matter if application controls tested well.
- C.** An IT general control; it weakens reliance on every application control the code supports.
- D.** A control limited to the redesigned point-of-sale screens.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is an application control rather than a general control?

- A.** Nightly off-site backups.
- B.** Approval of program changes before release.
- C.** Badge access to the data center.
- D.** A sales-order screen that rejects customers not in the customer master file.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A furniture manufacturer ~~with a showroom in Chicago~~ receives a customer order, ships the sofas, bills the customer, and collects payment. ~~Its warehouse uses barcode scanners installed last year.~~ Which transaction cycle covers these steps?

Target word: name the cycle **Decides:** Order, ship, bill, collect with a customer.

A	Correct	The customer-side sequence from order to cash.
B	Confusion set	That cycle summarizes all cycles; it does not process customer orders.
C	Camouflage	The scanners are background; the steps are selling and collecting.
D	Inverted operation	That is the vendor side: buying and paying.

2. Answer C Concept 2

At a nonprofit ~~with a \$3-million budget~~, one staff member opens the mail, deposits donor checks, and posts the receipts to the donor ledger. ~~She has worked there eleven years and is trusted by the board.~~ Which change best fixes the control weakness?

Target word: fix for the weakness **Decides:** Custody of checks and recording are held by one person.

A	Adjacent category	A useful compensating control, but it does not separate the duties.
B	Inverted operation	Adds another incompatible duty to the same person.
C	Correct	Separates custody from recording.
D	Camouflage	Trust is not a control; the design flaw remains.

3. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

An employee can both add new vendors to the vendor master file and approve payments to vendors. What fraud does this combination make easiest?

Target word: reverse: from the duties to the risk **Decides:** Control over both vendor setup and payment approval.

A	Confusion set	Lapping needs custody of customer payments.
B	Correct	She can invent the payee and authorize the cash out.
C	Dropped element	Ignores that the pair lets one person control the whole payment path.
D	Adjacent category	Needs access to the employee master file, not the vendor file.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A payroll clerk at a hospital ~~with 2,000 employees~~ keys 400 instead of 40.0 in the hours-worked field for one nurse. The system, ~~upgraded in January~~, rejects the entry because no one can work more than 80 hours in a pay period. Which input control caught the error?

Target word: name the control **Decides:** The value exceeded a set ceiling.

A	Confusion set	Checks data type; 400 is a valid number.
B	Correct	Rejects values above a maximum.
C	Adjacent category	Compares entries to a master file, such as valid employee IDs.
D	Dropped element	The field was filled in; nothing was missing.

5. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

A company wants to catch transposed digits in customer account numbers, such as 4721 keyed as 4271. Which control fits best?

Target word: reverse: from error to control **Decides:** Keying errors inside an ID number.

A	Inverted operation	The count still matches; it catches missing records, not wrong digits.
B	Adjacent category	Tests order of documents, not individual ID digits.
C	Confusion set	Tests size of a value, not ID accuracy.
D	Correct	A calculated digit fails when digits are transposed.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A clinic network's database has a Patients table with primary key PatientID and an Appointments table. Each appointment belongs to one patient, and a patient can have many appointments. ~~The database runs on servers in a data center two states away.~~ How should the tables be linked?

Target word: how to build the link **Decides:** One patient to many appointments.

A	Inverted operation	Repeats data and causes update anomalies.
B	Confusion set	Primary keys must be unique, but one patient has many appointments.
C	Adjacent category	Names are not unique identifiers.
D	Correct	The many side holds the one side's primary key.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A distributor ~~with 14 warehouses~~ replaces its separate sales, inventory, and accounting programs with an ERP system. ~~Its IT director came from a video game company.~~ What is the main benefit, and what is a main risk?

Target word: benefit and risk of ERP **Decides:** One shared, integrated database.

A	Correct	Shared data is the payoff; tight integration is also the risk.
B	Absolute language	ERPs need strong access and change controls.
C	Inverted operation	That describes the old, separate systems.
D	Camouflage	The director's background is not the ERP's core benefit or risk.

8. Answer A Concept 6

A bank ~~with 1.2 million customers~~ is replacing its core deposit system. Errors would be very costly, and the budget can support running two systems for a quarter. ~~The project manager holds a PMP certificate.~~ Which conversion method gives the lowest risk?

Target word: lowest-risk conversion **Decides:** High cost of failure and budget for two systems.

A	Correct	Old and new run together, so results can be compared and the old system is a fallback.
B	Inverted operation	The riskiest method: no fallback.
C	Confusion set	Limits the first rollout to one site but gives no side-by-side fallback.
D	Absolute language	Phasing spreads risk but is not safer than parallel for one core system.

9. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

A small firm switches from its old billing system to the new one overnight on a single date. Which method is this, and what is its key drawback?

Target word: reverse: from description to method and drawback **Decides:** One cutover date with no overlap.

A	Inverted operation	No overlap occurred.
B	Adjacent category	Right method, wrong drawback: direct is the least expensive.
C	Correct	Cheapest and fastest, but riskiest.
D	Confusion set	Pilot starts with one location; here everything switched.

10. Answer B Concept 7

An analyst at an insurance company ~~with 600 agents~~ needs a diagram showing where claims data comes from, which processes transform it, and where it is stored, without showing who does the work, which forms are used, or which computer runs it. ~~The analyst prefers blue shapes.~~ Which tool fits?

Target word: diagram type **Decides:** Logical view of data only, no people or devices.

A	Adjacent category	Shows computer programs, devices, and files.
B	Correct	Shows sources, processes, stores, and flows without physical detail.
C	Confusion set	Shows physical documents and who handles them.
D	Dropped element	Shows data structure but not processes or flows.

11. Answer C Concept 8

An IT auditor at a retailer ~~with 300 stores~~ finds that programmers can move code changes into production without approval. ~~The retailer's point-of-sale screens were recently redesigned.~~ What type of control is deficient, and why does it matter?

Target word: control type and impact **Decides:** Change management is a general control.

A	Confusion set	Input controls validate data entered, not program changes.
B	Inverted operation	Application tests rely on general controls to stay valid.
C	Correct	Unapproved changes could alter any program's controls.
D	Camouflage	The redesign is background; change management affects all systems.

12. Answer D Concept 8 • transfer

Which is an application control rather than a general control?

Target word: reverse: find the application control **Decides:** Works inside one transaction process.

A	Adjacent category	An IT operations control that supports all systems.
B	Confusion set	Change management is a general control.
C	Inverted operation	A general control over the IT environment.
D	Correct	An edit inside the sales application.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Transaction cycles	Revenue cycle = order, ship, bill, collect; expenditure cycle = order, receive, pay; production cycle = convert inputs to goods; HR/payroll = hire, pay employees.	Assigning a customer-facing flow to the expenditure or production cycle.	Who is on the other side: customer, vendor, factory floor, or employee.
2	Segregation of duties	Separate authorization, recording, and custody of assets so no one person can both commit and conceal an error or fraud.	Relying on a trusted employee, or adding another incompatible duty to the same person.	One person handles cash or assets and also records them.
3	Input controls	Field check = data type; limit check = value above a ceiling; range check = between two bounds; validity check = matches a master file; check digit = catches keying errors in IDs; completeness check = required fields filled.	Naming the wrong edit check for the error described.	What exactly was wrong with the entry.
4	Primary and foreign keys	Each table has a unique primary key; a related table links by holding that key as a foreign key, which avoids repeating data.	Copying all details into each row, or using a non-unique field as the link.	One-to-many relationships between tables.
5	ERP systems	An ERP integrates functions in one shared database, giving real-time, consistent data; risks include costly, complex implementation and errors that spread across modules.	Thinking an ERP removes the need for controls.	Separate departmental systems being replaced by one.
6	System conversion methods	Parallel = run old and new together (safest, costliest); direct = switch at once (cheapest, riskiest); pilot = one site first; phased = one module at a time.	Picking direct or phased when failure would be costly and budget allows parallel.	Cost of failure vs. budget for running two systems.
7	Data flow diagrams vs. flowcharts	A DFD shows data sources, processes, stores, and flows (logical view); flowcharts show physical documents, people, and systems.	Choosing a flowchart when the question excludes who, what forms, and which computer.	"Without showing who does the work."
8	General vs. application controls	IT general controls (access, change management, operations, backups) support all systems; application controls work inside one process (input edits, processing checks). Weak general controls undermine application controls.	Treating a change-management weakness as limited to one application.	Controls over programmers, data centers, and access vs. controls inside a transaction screen.

Course scope (public description): Accounting Information Systems (AIS for short) introduces students to AIS, with particular emphasis on the accountant's role in management and financial reporting systems. Topics include transaction cycles and related information technology (IT) controls, data management, enterprise resource planning (ERP) and e-commerce systems, systems development and acquisition, documentation, and IT auditing. D103 Intermediate Accounting I and D104 Intermediate Accounting II are the prerequisites to this course.